# Lesson 04 material: Pronunciation: Consonants and Linking

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

## 1.6: Consonants

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Original page, with audio and online exercises:
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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

**Objective**

The purpose of this lesson is to help students become aware of the consonant sounds that exist in American English. (Students will work more with consonant sounds in other units and sections.)

### Introduction to Consonants

There are 21 consonants in the English alphabet. Consonants include all letters that are not vowels (A,E,I,O and U).

### The Phonemic Chart

Look at the American English Phonemic Chart. The consonant sounds are found in the bottom three rows of the chart.

### Notice

**Sounds Move from Front to Back**

Start with /p/ sound on row 4 of the phonemic chart. Make each sound on that line. Notice how the sound starts at the front of your mouth and moves backwards.

**Voiced and Unvoiced Consonants**

Notice that voiced and unvoiced sounds are paired. For example: /p/ is unvoiced, /b/ is voiced. You will learn more about Voiced and Unvoiced consonants in Unit 2.

### Activity

Work with your teacher. Write a word that has the sound in each box. For example: words with a /p/ sound = people, place, pick, words with a /b/ sound = ball, bike, birthday.

### Other Resources

- American English Consonants
- Access an Interactive American English Phonemic Chart with sounds and examples.
- For Teachers: Watch the video Introduction to Teaching Pronunciation Workshop - Adrian Underhill to learn the sounds in the phonemic chart.

### Links on the original page

- American English Phonemic Chart: https://www.onestopenglish.com/download?ac=13639
- American English Consonants: https://easypronunciation.com/en/american-english-pronunciation-ipa-chart#american_english_consonants
- Introduction to Teaching Pronunciation Workshop - Adrian Underhill: https://youtu.be/1kAPHyHd7Lo

## 1.7: Linking Consonants to Vowels

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

**Audio for this section** is saved on your computer in `E:\personal-tutor\materials\library\esl-b1-speaking\attachments\01.07-linking-consonants-to-vowels`: Linking Listening Practice

### Linking Final Consonants to Words Beginning with a Vowel

### Rules to Remember

#### Rules to Remember: Linking Consonants to Vowels

When a word with a final consonant is followed by a word beginning with a vowel, we link the consonant to the vowel in the next word.

Why?

- The final consonant will be easier to say.
- Your speech will sound more natural.
- Understanding this rule will help improve your listening skills because you will start to hear when native speakers do this.

#### Examples

- time off ---> ti-moff
- date of ---> da-tof
- keep up ---> kee-pup
- at a ---> a-ta

#### Note

When linking a final /t/ to a vowel, the /t/ sound often changes to a fast "d" sound.

- Examples:
  - date of = da-dəv
  - at a = a-də

### Watch the Video

#### Rachel's English: Linking Consonants to Vowels

Video: https://youtu.be/7tsljuK4f2E

### Recording 1: Linking Final Consonants to Words Beginning with a Vowel

Read the sentences below. Practice saying them out loud with your partner. Focus on linking the underlined phrases. When you're ready, make a recording of yourself. Listen to the recording and make sure you have linked all the underlined phrases. Make a note of your mistakes, and then make the recording again. When your ready, submit your recording to your teacher.

____ / 11 points

1. What's up?
2. ten hours a day
3. That's what I thought.
4. What is it?
5. It's his anniversary.
6. I'm on the train.
7. This is too much.
8. Forget about it.

### PowerPoint: Linking Consonants to Vowels

Review the PowerPoint with your teacher. Linking Final Consonants to Vowels 2.pptx

Remember the Rule: The final consonant of the previous word often sounds like it's attached to the vowel in the next word.

- In the following slides, you will see examples of phrases in which final consonants are linked to beginning vowels.
  - Look at the pictures and examples to help you understand the meaning of each phrase.
  - Practice saying each underlined phrase with your teacher so you can hear the consonant to vowel linking.

### Quiz: Listening Practice

Listen to the recording and write in the missing words: (Audio on the lesson web page: "Linking Listening Practice") Make sure that you spell each word correctly. You can do this quiz as many times as you wish. This activity will help you to start to hear linking of consonants to vowels. (Look at the next page to check your answers.)

EXERCISE

**Fill in the missing words**

1. The Berlin Wall is between East and West Berlin. It's covered _____ _____ and graffiti.

2. Brandenburg Gate is a symbol _____ _____ between East and West Germany, so it's _____ _____ site to visit.

3. Tiergarten is _____ _____ the biggest parks in the city. It's a nice quiet _____ _____ from the city. It's _____ _____ wild deer _____ _____ animals.

4. If you want to see some cool _____ _____, then _____ _____ to Friedrichshain. There are _____ _____ _____ old warehouses that are now cafes and art galleries.

5. You can't come to Berlin and _____ _____ _____ Currywurst!

### Notice: Linking Practice

Practice finding and drawing a pronunciation feature. Find the consonants and draw a line linking them to vowel in the next word. (Look at the next page to check your answers.)

1. The Berlin Wall is between East and West Berlin. It's covered in art and graffiti.
2. Brandenburg Gate is a symbol of unity between East and West Germany, so it's an important site to visit.
3. Tiergarten is one of the biggest parks in the city. It's a nice quiet green escape from the city. It's full of wild deer and other animals.
4. If you want to see some cool street art, then head over to Friedrichshain. There are a lot of old warehouses that are now cafes and art galleries.
5. You can't come to Berlin and not eat a Currywurst!

### Recording 2: Linking Final Consonants to Words Beginning with a Vowel

Read the sentences below. Practice saying them out loud with your partner. Focus on linking the underlined phrases. When you're ready, make a recording of yourself. Listen to the recording and make sure you have linked all the underlined phrases. Make a note of your mistakes, and then make the recording again. When your ready, submit your recording to your teacher.

____/20 points

1. The Berlin Wall is between East and West Berlin. It's covered in art and graffiti.
2. Brandenberg Gate is a symbol of unity between East and West Germany, so it's an important site to visit.
3. Tiergarten is one of the biggest parks in the city. It's a nice quiet green escape from the city. It's full of wild deer and other animals.
4. If you want to see some cool street art, then head over to Friedrichshain. There are a lot of old warehouses that are now cafes and art galleries.
5. You can't come to Berlin, and not eat a currywurst.

### Attached: Linking Final Consonants to Vowels 2

Slide 1: 25 Things to do in Berlin / Linking Final Consonants to Vowels

Slide 2: Linking Consonants to Vowels / Remember the Rule: Final Consonants are linked to Beginning Vowels / In the following slides, you will see examples of phrases in which final consonants are linked to beginning vowels. / Look at the pictures and examples to help you understand the meaning of each phrase. / Practice saying each underlined phrase so you can hear the consonant to vowel linking.

Slide 3: Meaning of "covered in": There is art and / graffiti everywhere on the wall. / The Berlin Wall is between East and West Berlin. It's covered in art and graffiti. / Covered In

Slide 4: The children are covered in paint. / The dog is covered in mud. / Covered In - Examples

Slide 5: Meaning of "symbol of unity": a picture, thing, or person that reminds us of the connection and agreement / between groups of people (opposite: symbol of division) / Brandenburg Gate is a symbol of unity between East and West Germany, so it's an important site to visit. / A Symbol of Unity

Slide 6: The olympic rings are a symbol of unity for all the countries that participate. / A flag is a symbol of unity for a country. / Symbol of Unity - Examples

Slide 7: Meaning of “green escape”: a beautiful natural place with lots of plants and trees. You can go there for a rest or a break. / Tiergarten is one of the biggest parks in the city. It’s a nice quiet green escape from the city. / Green Escape

Slide 8: These are parks in New York and London. They offer a nice quiet green escape from the busy, noisy, stressful cities around them. / Green Escape – Examples

Slide 9: Meaning of “full of”: There are many many deer and other animals in the park. / It’s full of wild deer and other animals. / Full of

Slide 10: The room is full of people. / The glass is full of water. / Full of – Examples

Slide 11: Meaning of “head over”: an informal way to say “go” / . . . head over to Friedrichshain. / Head Over To

Slide 12: I’m going to head over to campus after my meeting. / Head over to my house after work and we’ll have dinner together. / Head Over To - Examples

Slide 13: Meaning: You have to eat a currywurst when you come to Berlin. Don’t miss it. It’s an important part of your trip. / You can’t come to Berlin and not eat a Currywurst! / You can’t come to _____ and not . . .

Slide 14: You can’t go to Thailand and not eat mango with sticky rice. / You can’t go to Mexico and not eat street tacos. / You can’t come to San Diego and not visit the beaches. / You can’t come to ____ and not . . . Examples